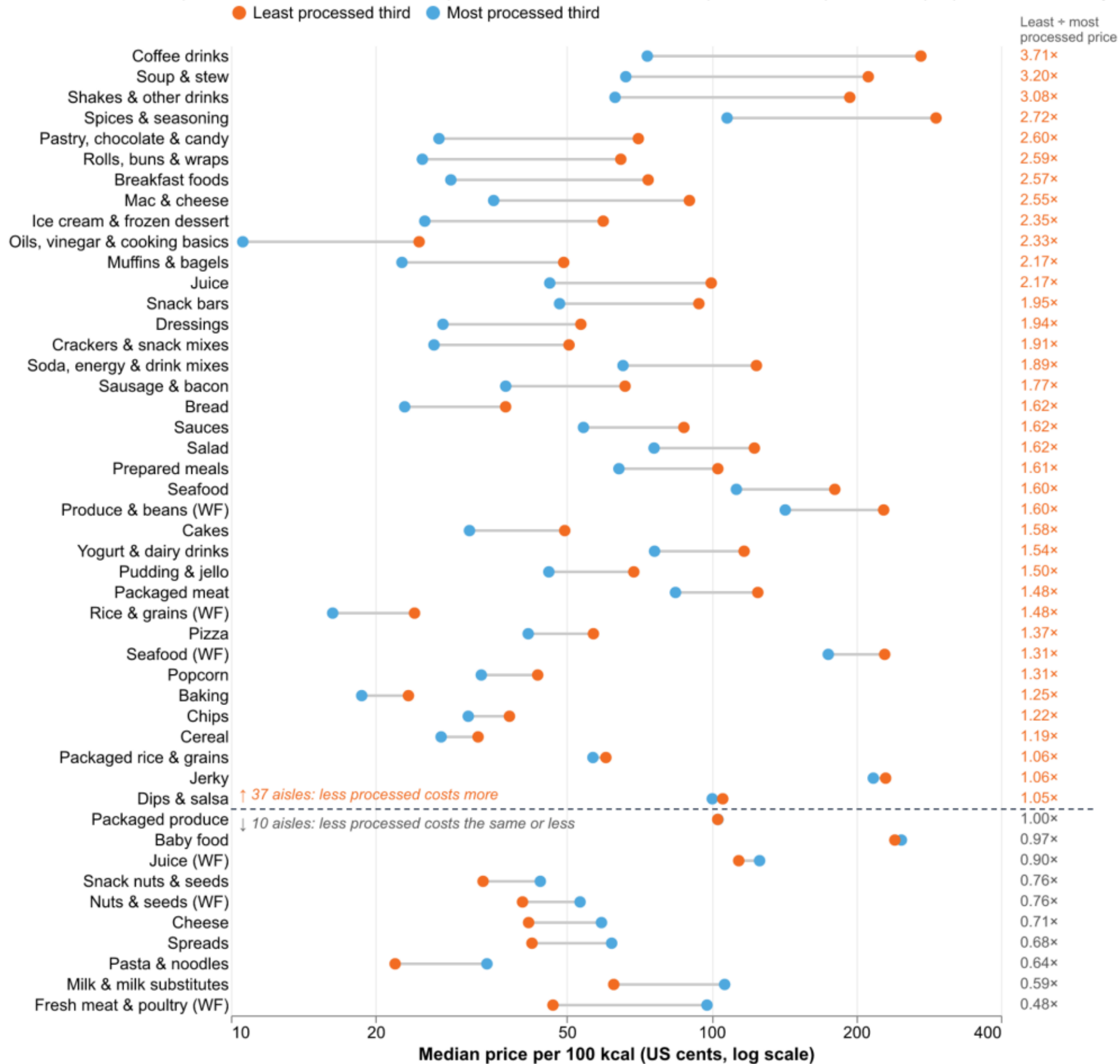


Plot A

## In most aisles, the less processed option costs more per calorie

In 37 of 47 aisles, the least processed third of items costs more per 100 kcal than the the most processed third (median aisle: 1.6× as much). Within each aisle, priced items are split into thirds by Food Processing Score; each dot is the median price of one third. Aisles shown have 60+ priced items and thirds at least 0.1 apart in median score; coffee beans (listed at ~0 kcal) are left out. (WF) = Whole Foods-only category.



## Plot B

### More than half of “organic” groceries are still ultra-processed

Each square is 1% of a group's items, filled from the least processed class (top) to ultra-processed (bottom).

Organic = the product name contains “organic” or “organics”. Class is GroceryDB's predicted NOVA class.

Part of the gap is mix: 19% of organic items are produce vs 7% of the rest. Within the same aisle, organic items score only 0.04 lower on the 0-1 Food Processing Score (median across 43 aisles with 15+ items of each kind).

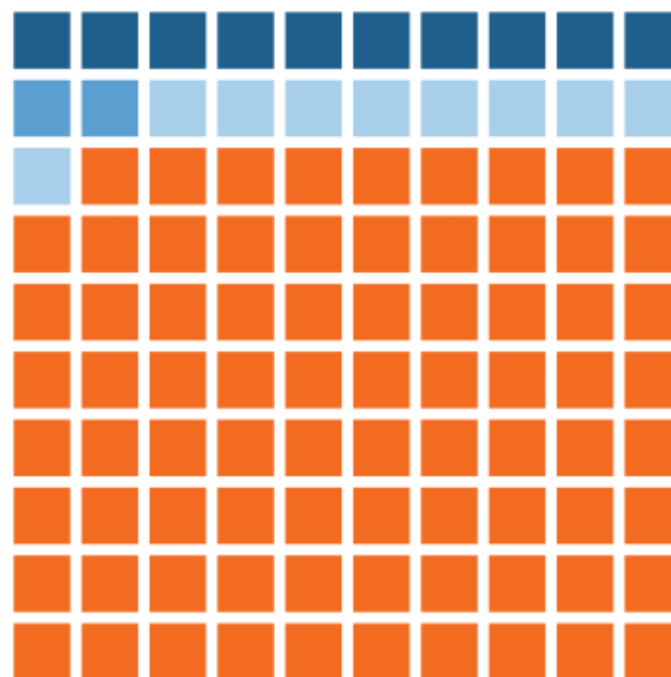
#### 56% ultra-processed

Name says organic (3,359 items)

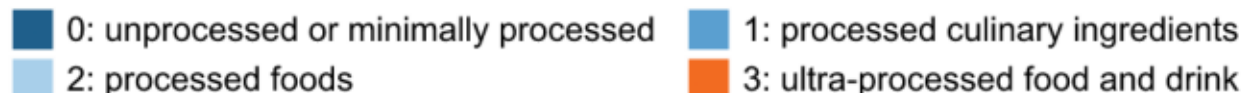


#### 79% ultra-processed

Everything else (22,891 items)



Processing class (predicted NOVA)



Plot C

In 16 of the 20 biggest aisles, at least 4 in 5 products are ultra-processed

Each dot is one product (19,046 in all) in the 20 aisles with the most items, placed by its Food Processing Score. Orange = predicted NOVA class 3 (ultra-processed). Class and score summarize the same model prediction differently, so the colors overlap from 0.5 to about 0.73. Dots are spread up and down at random within each row so they don't stack; height inside a row means nothing.



## Preferred plot

I prefer Plot A, the aisle-by-aisle price comparison. My first draft compared whole categories, so cheap processed aisles like bread sat next to expensive fresh meat, and it wasn't clear whether processing or the kind of food was driving the price. Plot A only compares items inside the same aisle, which takes the kind of food out of the comparison. Within each aisle I split the priced items into thirds by Food Processing Score and plot the median price per 100 kcal of the least and the most processed third. Position on a shared log axis carries the comparison, because prices run from about 10 to 300 cents and a linear axis would crush the cheap aisles together. Sorting by the ratio and drawing a divider lets the reader see the pattern (37 of 47 aisles above the line) before reading any numbers, and the ratio column gives the exact size for anyone who wants it. Orange always marks the less processed side, the same accent the other two plots use. Plot B makes one memorable point, that 56% of products with "organic" in the name are still ultra-processed, but it only shows a share, and within the same aisle organic items score just 0.04 lower, so the story is thinner than it first looks. Plot C is the most striking to look at and shows how little choice most big aisles offer, but its 19,046 dots describe what is on the shelf rather than what it costs a shopper, and the overlap between class and score takes explaining. Plot A has limits too. In heavily processed aisles the "least processed third" is still processed (its median score is 0.87 for muffins and bagels), and price per calorie flatters calorie-dense food. In the final version I'll show how far apart the two thirds are on the processing score and check whether price per gram tells the same story.